



INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL OF RESEARCH AND STUDIES

Month/Year : June 2026

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22026160>



RECEIVED
07-04-2026



ACCEPTED
29-04-2026



PUBLISHED
30-06-2026

LIBERIA'S GOVERNMENT POLICIES AND THEIR IMPACT ON THE STARTUP ECOSYSTEM

Joseph K.M Benson
Dr. Satvik Jain - Assistant Professor
Faculty of Commerce & Management,
Kalinga University, Chhattisgarh, Naya Raipur, India

ABSTRACT:

The policies of the government play a significant role in the startup ecosystem in many aspects, such as funding access, infrastructure building, regulations, and entrepreneurial education. In this research paper, the researcher investigates the issue of how government policies in Liberia have influenced creation and survival of new businesses, using the interviews with the Liberian company owners. A technique that is often employed in qualitative research, semi-structured interviews, was used to examine how entrepreneurial ventures are influenced by government programs, incentives, and regulatory frameworks. The results show that despite the success of such programs like Growth Accelerator Programme, the Youth Entrepreneurship Investment Bank, and the Liberia Innovative Fund for Entrepreneurship in helping companies develop, there are still constant setbacks that need to be overcome. A deficiency in entrepreneurial training at the national level inadequate infrastructure high utility costs, weak enforcement of rules and regulations and illiteracy are evident in this population. Startup entrepreneurs have reported that the startup ecosystem fails significantly in achieving success due to the absence of incentives and continuous support. Studies indicate that Liberia could improve policy enforcement expand entrepreneurial education at secondary and higher levels and provide infrastructure and financial support to new businesses.

Keywords: Government Policy; Startup Ecosystem; Entrepreneurship; Liberia; Economic Development

INTRODUCTION

Startups are widely believed to enhance innovation employment and gross domestic product (GDP) but government policies play a crucial role in creating a supportive environment for their success. The Liberian government has introduced several programs including the Liberia Innovative Fund for Entrepreneurship the Youth Entrepreneurship Investment Bank and the Growth Accelerator Programme to support economic recovery and diversification by encouraging new business formation. Despite these efforts challenges such as weak entrepreneurship education poor regulatory enforcement high operational costs and inadequate infrastructure persist (Dennis 2003). Understanding the impact of government policies on the opportunities and challenges faced by startups is essential to attract investment promote balanced economic growth in Liberia and support sustainable entrepreneurship. Empowering the private sector to build a successful future the MSMEs Growth Accelerator Program has supported numerous Liberian businesses from diverse backgrounds demonstrating its transformative potential. The latest phase aims to accelerate progress by fostering innovation, strengthening firm capabilities and improving access to finance. The initiative was funded by Accountability Lab Liberia and co-designed implemented and managed by iCampus Liberia.

(Gibson, 2001) Business Development Service Providers like East Africa Market Development Associates, Business Startup Centre Monrovia, Agro Tech Liberia, and Growth Africa advise, educate, and help entrepreneurs. The event enabled the government to reiterate the support it offered to MSMEs. Deputy Minister of Commerce and Trade Wilmot A. Reeves emphasized the importance of business to the development of the country. (Johnson, 2022) According to Reeves, the deputy minister, the MSMEs are the economic pillars of Liberia. He was right. It is imperative to support them to achieve long-term economic growth and job creation. Our government is determined to be successful as part of our ARREST Agenda of economic change. He said that a consistent policy reform and alliances would be necessary to establish the environment in which the company can grow and that the economy of Liberia had to be diversified to access the potential of the young population-over 60% of whom are under 25. Increasing Collaborations for Effect In the launch, four leading financial institutions in Liberia, Bloom Bank Africa, Ecobank Liberia Ltd., International Bank Liberia Limited (IBLL), and United Bank for Africa (UBA), confirmed their commitment as strategic investment partners by signing or renewing Memoranda of Understanding

(MoUs) Also, partners in different parts of the world have been key in the effort. The Community-Based Forest Management Project and the LEH GO GREEN Project have received additional financial support from the European Union Delegation to Liberia and the Swedish Embassy in Monrovia respectively. These contributions highlight the role of development partners in Liberia in promoting long-term economic growth while protecting the environment. The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) Resident Representative in Liberia Aliou Dia expressed optimism that this initiative would contribute to positive change. Dia stated that collaboration with Liberian entrepreneurs reflects a shared vision of a strong and self-reliant nation. He emphasized that empowering women and youth remains a priority with plans to expand inclusive opportunities including women-focused entrepreneurial programs. He encouraged Liberians to think ambitiously noting that innovative and bold ideas will shape the country's economic future. By referring to global success stories such as those of Dangote and Bill Gates he urged Liberians to pursue large-scale aspirations.

From Dream to Reality: The Growth Accelerator's Impact While reviewing the program's outcomes Luther D. Jeke Chief Executive Officer of iCampus Liberia noted that 168 businesses from seven counties applied during the first call for applications in 2021. Following coaching, mentoring and evaluation, five firms were awarded grants of forty thousand dollars each demonstrating the program's practical support for local entrepreneurs. The next cohort also launched in 2021 with a focus on agricultural cooperatives received 264 applications and supported 26 businesses. In 2023 the program gained increased backing from four financial institutions and international partners committed to entrepreneurial development. Mr. Jeke stated that the success of the initiative is linked to Liberia's government strategy which prioritizes inclusive economic growth and encourages entrepreneurial activity.

P.S. Leaders are Committed.

The Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of UBA Liberia, Mr. Ayokunle Olajubi, reiterated his desire to help in the development of the business environment within the country. He stressed that this initiative is a new era in the life of Liberia, whose purpose is both to find entrepreneurs and empower them to go beyond the small and medium enterprise (SME) level and make a difference in business and society (Olajubi, 2023). The need to create a robust and well-

diversified economy with a thriving local business community also was emphasized by representatives of partner banks and international organizations, and their support and commitment towards the project were expressed (European Union, 2023). Entrepreneurs in Liberia are on a bright future. The MSMEs Progress Accelerator Program has continued to shine some hope in the lives of small businesses in Liberia especially to young women and girls who hold the key to the future of the country in terms of economic growth (Swedish Embassy, 2023). Through the continuous collaboration with the national and international partners, such as the Swedish Embassy and the European Union, the program is likely to help Liberia move on a faster track towards the sustainable development. The introduction of the fifth cohort again confirms the interest of Liberia in using the private sector as an instrument of inclusive and sustainable development thus providing a pathway to larger society change (European Union, 2023). Entrepreneurial development in Liberia faces several challenges. Like many other African countries Liberia has struggled with unemployment poverty the aftermath of civil conflict and disease outbreaks all of which hinder the growth of entrepreneurship. Although about 65 percent of the population consists of youth over 85 percent of young people are unemployed (United Nations 2022; United Nations Development Programme 2021). These conditions create significant barriers to entrepreneurial activity. Researchers have identified several obstacles affecting business development in Liberia including the following:

- a. Inadequate basic knowledge of science and technology.** Entrepreneurs play a key role in economic development by creating and transforming businesses that benefit society. However, such innovation requires a basic understanding of science and technology. In Liberia many entrepreneurs lack computer and technological skills which limits their competitiveness and growth in modern markets (World Bank 2021; International Labour Organization 2020).
- b. High cost of doing business in Liberia.** Another major challenge is the high cost associated with running businesses. Poor infrastructure, high transportation, inaccessibility of finances and unstable electricity are factors that make doing business more expensive to the entrepreneurs, thus deterring the expansion and investment of a business (World Bank, 2021).
- c. Lack of Incentives.** A subsidy is a form of government support which boosts supply of products and services by providing grants to companies or individuals, financial aid or relief of taxes.

Liberia has discouraged entrepreneurship due to poor incentive mechanisms that can encourage the local business and industries. A large percentage of startups fail within six to twelve months due to lack of support facilities such as subsidies, tax break and access to operating capital by the government (World Bank, 2021). Entrepreneurship and economic development. Entrepreneurship is a key factor influencing economic development. Numerous studies have shown a strong link between entrepreneurship and economic growth, highlighting its significant role in national development (Acs et al. 2018; Audretsch 2020). It is widely regarded as essential for long-term sustainable economic progress and can even revive declining economies (Neumann 2021). Entrepreneurship has expanded globally due to its effectiveness in driving economic growth and innovation. Over the past two decades it has made substantial contributions to wealth creation and technological advancement. In addition to economic benefits, it enhances innovation and competitiveness. Researchers suggest that successful entrepreneurs possess risk-taking ability innovation and the capacity to identify and exploit new opportunities (Hisrich et al. 2017). Poverty in Liberia is estimated at about 55.5 percent and is projected to rise to 68.9 percent due to the economic effects of the COVID-19 pandemic. The pandemic resulted in the loss of approximately 114 million jobs globally since 2019 including in countries such as Liberia (International Labour Organization 2021). Supporting entrepreneurial activities has been identified as a key strategy to address unemployment and economic challenges caused by the pandemic (Rana 2021). Over the past 30 years the emergence of new businesses has been a major driver of economic growth. Entrepreneurs act as innovators who introduce new ideas and transform them into practical solutions that advance the economy (Schumpeter 1934; Drucker 1985). In many cases the transition from a developing to a developed economy has been driven by entrepreneurial activity.

a. **Entrepreneurship fosters employment.** Entrepreneurs play an important role in job creation both directly and indirectly. Self-employment provides individuals with a source of income while also generating employment opportunities for others. As businesses grow, they create additional jobs reducing unemployment and improving economic conditions (Acs et al. 2018).

b. **Entrepreneurship supports regional development.** Entrepreneurs often explore opportunities in underdeveloped and underserved areas. By establishing businesses in these regions, they help reduce regional disparities. This development improves infrastructure such as healthcare education and recreational services contributing to overall regional progress (World Bank 2021).

c. **Entrepreneurship contributes to economic independence.** A high level of entrepreneurial activity can lead to economic self-reliance. Entrepreneurs stimulate domestic production reduce dependence on imports and increase exports strengthening the national economy (Porter 1990).

d. **Entrepreneurship promotes innovation.** Entrepreneurs drive innovation by introducing new ideas, improving production processes and delivering better services. Their activities enhance efficiency and productivity leading to economic growth (Schumpeter 1934). Entrepreneurship Enhances Living Standard. Entrepreneurship is crucial in enhancing living standards through increased accessibility and affordability of goods and services. The quality of the product offered by the entrepreneur at low prices due to innovation and mass production therefore enhances the quality of life of citizens (Drucker, 1985)

OBJECTIVES

1. To examine and assess current government policies and regulatory frameworks in Liberia that are focused on nurturing entrepreneurship and startups.
2. To find out the major challenges and obstacles encountered by startups as a result of government policies or as a result of their implementation.
3. To determine the role of fiscal policies, tax incentives, and financial support programs in growth, sustainability, and scalability of Liberian startups.
4. To investigate how government initiatives, such as public-private partnerships and incubation programs, affect innovation, technological adoption and competitiveness among startups.
5. To make recommendations to improve the policy to increase the overall growth, sustainability and global competitiveness of the startup ecosystem in Liberia.

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. What are the challenges facing Liberian startups despite the existing government policies to promote entrepreneurship?
2. How do the policies of Liberia impact the growth of the startup ecosystem, its sustainability, and its financial impact?

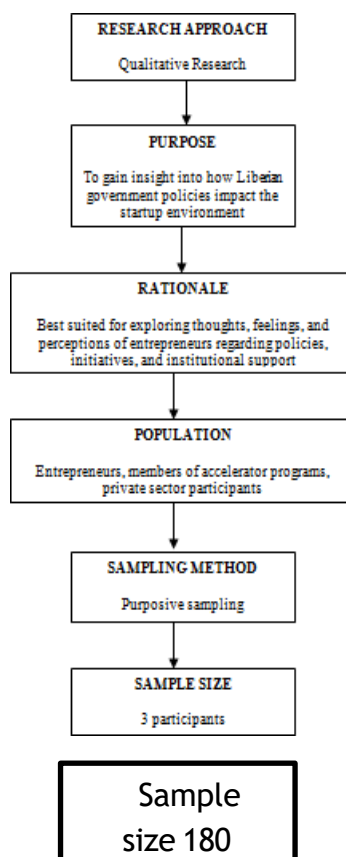
3. Will government initiatives, including those that educate and develop entrepreneurship, help companies develop in Liberia?

METHODOLOGY

This research takes the form of qualitative research to understand in more depth how government policies in Liberia impact the startup ecosystem. To understand the perceptions, experiences, and attitudes of individuals toward policies, institutional support, and entrepreneurial initiatives, qualitative research is especially suitable (Creswell and Creswell, 2018). The method will also allow a detailed view of the impacts of government practices, incentives and regulatory frameworks on the growth, sustainability and financial contributions of Liberian entrepreneurs. Because of the limitations and scope of the study, it was not possible to gather data about the whole population. Thus, the research was aimed at a specific audience of respondents such as entrepreneurs, participants of accelerator programs, and private sector stakeholders. Purposive sampling method was used to sample those who have relevant knowledge and experience with the topic of the research (Patton, 2015).

The interviews were in-depth semi-structured, and three participants were used to gather data. This approach was flexible in questioning and ensured that the important themes of the objectives of the research were covered. The semi-structured design allowed the respondents to give their opinions openly and the qualitative data obtained was rich and detailed in terms of the effectiveness, challenges and opportunities which come with government policies in the Liberian startup ecosystem. Even though the sample size was small, it was enough to produce meaningful insights and reach depth of understanding. This was a method that enabled the researcher to get into the minds of the participants and yet have a manageable and focused data gathering procedure (Guest et al., 2006).

Figure 1. Framework for Methodology



Government Programs and Publicity by Government Bodies to Support Startups

The government of Liberia has made significant efforts to promote the growth of startups and small businesses through various policies and institutional frameworks. These initiatives seek to establish a supportive business environment by enhancing access to finance, lowering regulatory barriers and promoting entrepreneurship nationwide.

A key institution supporting startups is the Central Bank of Liberia which plays a vital role in improving access to finance. Through financial inclusion policies and collaboration with commercial banks it promotes lending to small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) enabling startups to secure capital for establishment and expansion (Central Bank of Liberia 2020).

Additionally, the Liberia Revenue Authority assists small businesses by offering tax incentives and simplifying tax procedures. These measures ease the financial burden on startups and

encourage formal business registration (LRA 2021). The government's broader development strategy the Pro-Poor Agenda for Prosperity and Development (PAPD) also highlights private sector growth and entrepreneurship as major drivers of economic development (Government of Liberia 2018). Moreover, the government has introduced measures to improve access to essential inputs and reduce trade barriers. By facilitating the import of raw materials and intermediate goods startups can operate more efficiently and remain competitive in the market (World Bank 2022). From an institutional perspective several government bodies support business development. The Ministry of Commerce and Industry (Liberia) regulates and promotes commercial activities. Likewise, the Liberia Business Registry streamlines the business registration process making it easier for entrepreneurs to formalize their ventures. The National Investment Commission (Liberia) also supports startups by attracting investment and creating opportunities for expansion.

In terms of financial assistance startups in Liberia benefit from various institutions including commercial banks such as Ecobank Liberia and microfinance organizations. These institutions provide loans, credit services and financial guidance which are essential for the growth and sustainability of new businesses (IMF 2021). Non-governmental organizations and business associations also play a significant role in the startup ecosystem. The Liberia Chamber of Commerce advocates for policies that promote private sector development. Additionally initiatives such as the Youth Entrepreneurship and Employment Project (YEEP) offer training mentorship and funding opportunities to young entrepreneurs. International organizations including the World Bank and the United Nations Development Programme further support entrepreneurship in Liberia through capacity-building programs and financial assistance. These government initiatives and institutional supports have helped create a more favorable environment for startups in Liberia. Although challenges such as limited access to finance and infrastructure constraints persist, continued policy support and institutional strengthening are expected to enhance the startup ecosystem in the future.

RESULT

Research Question 1:

What are some of the barriers faced by Liberian firms despite government efforts to promote entrepreneurship?

Theme 1: Government Incentives

All three individuals consulted indicated that, although there are government initiatives aimed at enhancing entrepreneurship, the lack of adequate financial incentives remains a major constraint for startups. Participant 3 argued that incentives can motivate entrepreneurs to take risks and make strategic decisions that benefit both their businesses and the wider economy (United Nations Development Programme, 2021). However, the absence of clear and accessible incentive schemes limits the ability of businesses to grow, even when programs such as the Growth Accelerator Programme and Youth Entrepreneurship initiatives are available (World Bank, 2022).

Theme 2: Limited Government Support

Another major barrier identified is the lack of sufficient government support and protection. Respondents 1, 2, and 3 emphasized that entrepreneurs often experience inadequate institutional backing and limited protection against foreign competition. Due to the relatively lower prices of imported goods, local startups struggle to compete effectively in the domestic market. Respondent 1 suggested that imposing taxes on imported goods could help protect domestic industries.

In addition, corruption was identified as a significant challenge, with businesses sometimes required to pay informal fees to access services or obtain regulatory approvals. This increases operational costs and discourages potential entrepreneurs from entering the market (International Monetary Fund, 2021).

Theme 3: Inadequate Infrastructure

Infrastructure challenges, particularly unreliable electricity supply and poor road networks, were consistently highlighted as major obstacles. Respondents noted that frequent power outages and inadequate transportation systems negatively affect supply chains, production efficiency, and overall business performance. As a result, many startups rely on costly alternatives such as generators to maintain operations.

Improving infrastructure is essential not only for startup growth but also for broader economic development, as it creates a multiplier effect across sectors (World Bank, 2022).

Theme 4: High Cost of Utilities

The high cost of utilities, including water and internet services, was also identified as a significant barrier. Respondent 1 explained that due to high water costs, their company had to invest in drilling a private well, leading to increased expenses. Similarly, Respondent 2 emphasized the importance of affordable and reliable internet for business operations but noted that current costs are prohibitively high.

These high utility costs increase operational expenses and limit the competitiveness of startups in both local and international markets, thereby undermining the effectiveness of government initiatives aimed at promoting entrepreneurship (United Nations Development Programme, 2021).

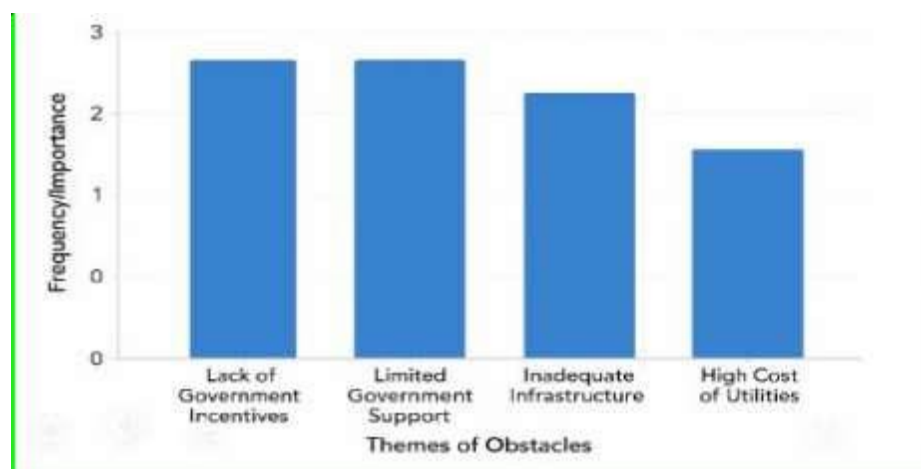


Figure 2. Major Obstacles Faced by Liberian Startups Figure 2 Interpretation

Figure 2 highlights the main obstacles faced by businesses in Liberia. The lack of government incentives and limited government support are the most frequently cited challenges, each with a relatively high importance score. Inadequate infrastructure also remains a significant barrier, while the high cost of utilities, though still impactful, is comparatively less emphasized. These findings suggest that systemic issues particularly insufficient government backing and infrastructural gaps are more critical obstacles than operational costs (World Bank, 2022; United Nations Development Programme, 2021).

Research Question 2:

What effects do Liberia's policies have on the startup ecosystem's expansion, viability, and financial contributions?

Theme 1: Societal Benefits

Respondents consistently emphasized that entrepreneurship, when supported by government policy, generates significant societal benefits. Startups create employment opportunities, which help reduce unemployment and improve living standards. As businesses expand, they require skilled labor, leading to job creation and contributing to reductions in poverty and crime.

Respondent 2 highlighted that government-supported entrepreneurship increases competition in local markets, which can result in more affordable goods and services compared to imported alternatives (United Nations Development Programme, 2021). Furthermore, interviewees noted that government-backed initiatives encourage innovation by providing startups with the resources, training, and support needed to develop new products and services. This not only addresses immediate societal challenges but also fosters a more adaptive and resilient entrepreneurial ecosystem (World Bank, 2022).

Theme 2: Economic Benefits

Respondents also highlighted the positive economic impacts of government policies on startup performance. Startups contribute to the national tax base, enabling the government to fund public services such as infrastructure, education, and healthcare. Participants 2 and 3 noted that promoting local entrepreneurship can reduce Liberia's dependence on imports while encouraging export-oriented production, thereby improving the country's trade balance and supporting economic growth (International Monetary Fund, 2021).

zzIn addition, government efforts such as financial support, mentorship programs, and infrastructure development aim to enhance the scalability and sustainability of startups. These initiatives help businesses grow, become more resilient, and contribute to long-term economic development. Overall, such policies play a crucial role in enabling startups to generate both social and economic value for the country (World Bank, 2022).

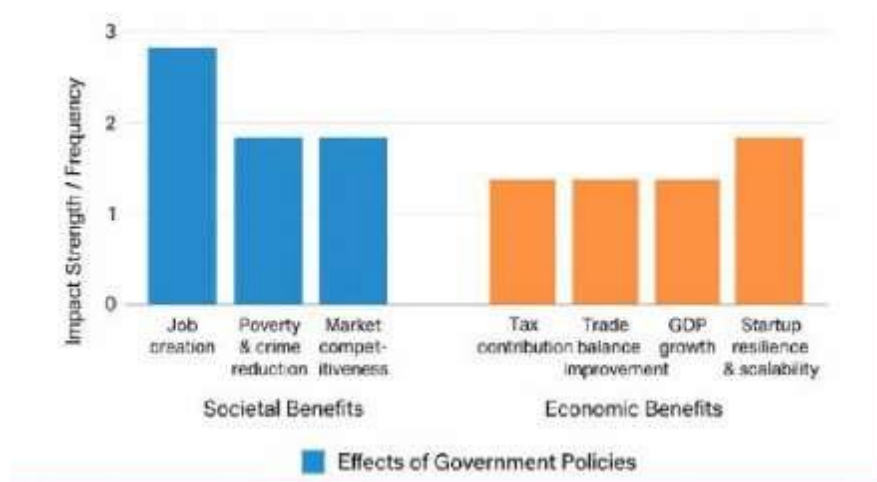


Figure 3. Effect Of Liberia's Policies on Startup Ecosystem

Figure 3 illustrates the societal and economic benefits that government policies can generate. Societal benefits such as job creation stand out as the strongest impact, followed by poverty and crime reduction, and improved market competitiveness. On the economic side, benefits are somewhat more evenly distributed, with startup resilience and scalability showing the greatest influence, followed by contributions to GDP growth, trade balance improvement, and tax revenue. This indicates that government policies not only strengthen social welfare but also contribute to a stable entrepreneurial environment that drives sustainable economic growth

Research Question 3: Can government programs, such as those that teach and foster entrepreneurship, help Liberia's companies grow?

Theme 1: Schools and Universities Curriculum

As all three of the interviewees have said, there is a huge obstacle in the startup ecosystem in Liberia, and it is caused by the absence of entrepreneurship education in secondary and higher institutions. According to, a number of the participants expressed the belief that if high schools and colleges offered courses on the topic, more individuals would be interested in pursuing careers in entrepreneurship. This kind of education, which would provide students with a basic understanding of how to establish and operate a business, might lead to a more entrepreneurial spirit and a reduced dependence on government employment. The importance of receiving support from the government for the execution of these programs was emphasized by the respondents as a

means of developing a capable and innovative startup workforce.

Theme 2: Entrepreneurship Awareness and Support Programs

The absence of knowledge about entrepreneurship is another significant hurdle to the establishment of businesses, as reported by the respondents. If school districts offered classes on entrepreneurship, adolescents

and young adults would be more aware of the advantages of starting their own businesses and would be more inclined to consider it as a viable career path. Training platforms, financial assistance, and incentives are examples of government initiatives that can potentially provide

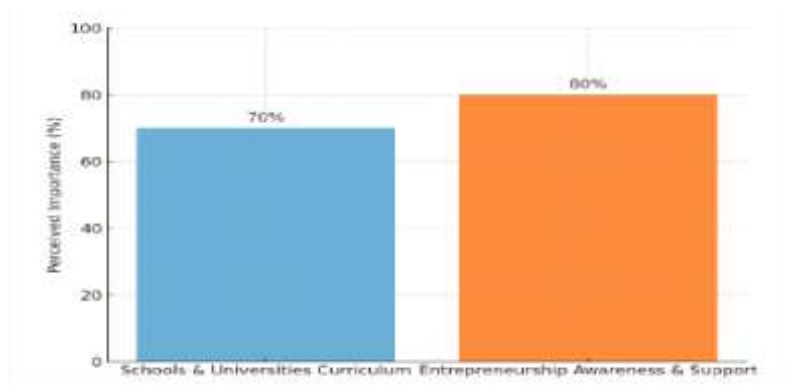


Figure 4. Role of Government Programs in Supporting Entrepreneurship in Liberia

Figure 4 chart focuses on the perceived importance of schools and universities incorporating entrepreneurship into their curriculum, alongside awareness and support programs. Respondents assign 70% importance to educational integration, while entrepreneurship awareness and government support programs are rated even higher at 80%. This reveals that while formal education plays a vital role in equipping future entrepreneurs with essential skills, practical support systems and awareness-building initiatives from the government are viewed as slightly more critical in driving entrepreneurial growth in Liberia significant assistance in the development of firms, according to an additional point raised by Participant. By combining educational efforts with programs that provide structured help, the government may encourage the development of an entrepreneurial spirit. This would create an environment in which new enterprises can emerge and prosper, so contributing to Liberia's economic progress.

Impact of Government Policies on the Growth and Sustainability of Liberia's Startup Ecosystem

The government policies of Liberia have had a significant impact on the growth and endurance of the startup ecosystem. This impact resulted from initiatives such as the Micro Small and Medium Enterprises Growth Accelerator Programme and collaborations between the public and private sectors. The Growth Accelerator offers mentorship training and financial support to startups and small businesses backed by the United Nations Development Programme and the government. Since 2021 the program has delivered over \$1.7 million in co-financing to 92 micro small and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs) and agricultural cooperatives while more than 110 local entrepreneurs have received support for business expansion. In 2025 ten high-potential small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) participated in the fifth bootcamp on strategic planning and financial literacy strengthening their readiness for scaling.

Financial support for these initiatives has partly been provided through grants. In one cohort five firms received \$40000 each while in another twenty Liberian businesses were awarded the same amount. In 2022 grant competitions under the Growth Accelerator supported by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) distributed \$860000 to agricultural cooperatives and MSMEs. Alongside direct funding government policies have promoted digital development and infrastructure expansion. Investments in telecommunications including over 725 kilometers of fiber optic cable and an increase in mobile coverage stations from 180 to 630 have enabled startups to access wider markets and grow more rapidly. Despite efforts to create a supportive entrepreneurial environment these measures indicate that continued financial incentives mentorship and infrastructure development remain necessary to sustain entrepreneurial growth and economic expansion in Liberia.

CONCLUSION

The study concludes that government policies in Liberia significantly influence the development sustainability and economic impact of the startup ecosystem. Entrepreneurship plays a vital role in job creation, poverty reduction and economic diversification while also improving social and economic well-being. However, startups continue to face challenges such as high utility costs, inadequate infrastructure, limited government support and insufficient financial incentives despite initiatives like the Growth Accelerator Programme and the Youth Entrepreneurship Investment Bank. Addressing these issues is essential to strengthen the startup ecosystem and enhance its contribution to Liberia's economic development.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Addressing policy and incentive gaps: The Liberian government should ensure effective policy implementation legislative support and alignment with startup needs. Expanding financial incentives and structured support programs can encourage entrepreneurs to establish and sustain their businesses.
2. Recognizing economic contributions: The government should acknowledge and promote entrepreneurship as a key driver of economic development. Startups can generate income create employment, foster innovation and provide solutions to economic challenges and policies should support these outcomes.
3. Promoting entrepreneurship education: Entrepreneurship education should be integrated into school and institutional curricula to equip students with the skills needed to start and manage businesses. Combined with government initiatives such as training mentorship and financial support this can strengthen Liberia's startup ecosystem.

The study emphasizes the importance of entrepreneurship education targeted support programs and clear government policies in strengthening businesses encouraging innovation and accelerating sustainable economic development in Liberia.

REFERENCES

1. Dennis, S. M., & Kaba, A. (2003). Assessing the Needs of Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) in Liberia: A Case Study of Montserrado County. *Journal of Small Business and Entrepreneurship*, 16(1), 57-74.
2. Dennis, S. M., & Kaba, A. (2019). Challenges Facing Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Liberia: A Case Study of Montserrado County. *Journal of Business and Entrepreneurship Development*, 3(2), 1-17.
3. Gibson, T., & Weah, A. (2001). The Impact of Microfinance on Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises in Liberia. *Journal of Small Business and Entrepreneurship*, 15(4), 1-12.
4. Goffe, J. (2011). An Empirical Study of the Challenges Faced by Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) in Liberia. *International Journal of Economics, Commerce and Management*, 9(5), 39-53.
5. Johnson, E. (2002). The Role of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Post-Conflict Liberia: A Case Study of Monrovia. *Journal of Development and Entrepreneurship*, 7(2), 151-172.
6. World Bank Amid COVID-19 Pandemic, Liberia has a chance for a robust recovery [Online] (2020a)

DOI: <https://www.worldbank.org/en/news/pressrelease/2020/07/30/amid-covid-19-pandemic-liberia-has-a-chance-for-a-robust-recovery-says-new-world-bank-report>

7. S. De Mel, S. Elder, M. Vansteenkiste, Labour market transitions of young women and men in Liberia [Online] (2013) DOI: https://www.ilo.org/wcmsp5/groups/public/---dgreports/---dcomm/documents/publication/wcms_228127.pdf
8. All Africa Liberia: The current and future roles of the IT Department [Online] (2021) DOI: <https://allafrica.com/stories/202109170948.html>
9. Ndedi, Entrepreneurship and Wealth Creation at the African Bottom of the Pyramid [Online] (2009) DOI: https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=1799125
10. USA.Gov. Liberia – Country Commercial Guide [Online]. (2021) DOI: <https://www.trade.gov/country-commercial-guides/liberia-market-overview>
11. V.E. David, Y. John, S. Hussain, Journal of Cycles Waste Management 22, 1299-1317 (2020)
12. W. Knudson, Wysocki, J. Champagne, C. Peterson, American Journal of Agricultural Economics 86(5), 1330-1337 (2004)
13. W.J. Baumol, Journal of Business Venturing 8(3), 197-210 (1993)
14. T. Neumann, Management Quarterly Review 71, 553-584 (2021)
15. R.D. Hisrich, M.P. Peters, D.A. Shepherd, Entrepreneurship (McGraw Hill, NY, 2019)
16. D.B. Audretsch, A.R. Thurik, Industrial and Corporate Change 10(1), 267-315 (2001)
17. OECD. One year of SME and entrepreneurship policy responses to COVID-19: Lessons learned to “build back better” (2021) DOI: <https://www.oecd.org/coronavirus/policy-responses/one-year-of-sme-and-entrepreneurship-policy-responses-to-covid-19-lessons-learned-to-build-back-better9a230220/>
18. World Economic Forum 4 ways to build businesses that work for good, right now (2019) DOI: <https://www.weforum.org/agenda/2019/11/from-b-corps-to-zebras-4-businesses-that-work-for-good/>
19. A.S. Kritikos, Entrepreneurs and their impact on jobs and economic growth [Online] (2014) DOI: <https://wol.iza.org/articles/entrepreneurs-and-their-impact-on-jobs-and-economic-growth/long>

20. E. Glaeser, Roles of entrepreneurship in economic development of a country [Online]. (2020) DOI: <https://evoma.com/business-centre/2020/7-roles-of-entrepreneurship-ineconomic-development-of-acountry/#:~:text=Entrepreneurs%20again%20play%20a%20key,other%20stakeholders%20in%20the%20community>
21. H. Lune, B.L. Berg, Qualitative research methods for the social sciences (9th ed.) (Pearson, UK, 2017
22. Kamara, A. F., & Baysah, M. M. (2009). Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises (SMEs) Financing and Performance in Liberia: A Case Study of Selected SMEs in Monrovia. *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 10(5), 67-78.
23. Kamara, M. J., & Kollie, E. B. (2014). Assessing the Growth Constraints of Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) in Liberia: A Case Study of Selected SMEs in Montserrado County. *International Journal of Academic Research in Business and Social Sciences*, 4(10), 95-107.
24. Kollie, E. B. (2012). The Impact of Entrepreneurship Training on Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) Performance in Liberia. *Journal of Small Business and Entrepreneurship Development*, 1(2), 21-34.
25. Kollie, E. B., & Johnson, L. (2016). Challenges Faced by Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) in Accessing Credit Facilities in Liberia. *Journal of Development and Agricultural Economics*, 8(4), 57-65.
26. Massaquoi, M., Tarawalie, A. B., & Turay, M. (2017). Access to Finance and Performance of Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) in Liberia. *International Journal of Academic Research in Business and Social Sciences*, 7(6), 27-41.
27. Menon, M. A. (2013). Constraints Faced by Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Liberia: A Case Study of Montserrado County. *International Journal of Academic Research in Business and Social Sciences*, 3(10), 303-316.
28. Minikon, H. S., & Johnson, E. (2005). Entrepreneurship Development and Small Business Growth in Liberia. *International Journal of Entrepreneurship and Small Business*, 2(2), 127-140.
29. Nushann, B. (2010). Barriers to Small Business Development in Post-Conflict Liberia: A Case Study of Montserrado County. *Journal of Small Business and Entrepreneurship Development*, 1(1), 56-72.
30. Nyanneh, B. M., & Kamara, A. F. (2006). Access to Finance and Performance of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Liberia. *Journal of Economics and Sustainable Development*, 4(2), 105-120.